

Unison

A sync tool for Windows and Linux that is run from the command line



Xmarks

Use the Xmarks Firefox plugin to synchronise your bookmarks across PCs

DO YOUR STUFF ONLINE

Use online services to do the work of installable applications. We tell you how.

Head over to www.zamzar.com for a quick and easy way to convert .docx files to .doc. Simply upload a file and a converted file will be sent to your email address.

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and capture your screen video

Printing webpages is a rather messy affair. Often you don't want certain elements to be printed. printwhatyoulike.com lets you enter any url, edit the page, and print it. No more pasting into Word. And you save on costs.

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save on both transfers and time. However, Dropbox is slightly restrictive because it allows syncing only through the "Dropbox Folder". This is quite like SugarSync's Magic Briefcase, but its use in SugarSync is optional. But syncing through one folder might well be convenient for some users. Surprisingly, Dropbox uses almost no interface and yet it is easy to use. Clicking on the system tray icon opens the Dropbox Folder. Right clicking on the files and folders brings up individual manipulation options. In the Preferences you can specify how much bandwidth you want to allocate to Dropbox, and specify connectivity options. The free version lets you sync up to 2 GB of data. Upgrading to a pro account with 50 GB of space will set you back by \$99 a year.

Synclipcity [synclipcity.com] For the cloud player

Synclipcity is very similar to Dropbox but has a few cloud-interfacing features in addition to the standard synchronisation. It has the added functionality of being able to integrate with Google Docs, Zoho online Word Processor, and Scribd online document viewer. Besides these, it can also sync photos from your native folders into Facebook albums. Hence, this is ideally suited to those who depend heavily on cloud-based services such as Google Docs. Changes to online documents will automatically be reflected in

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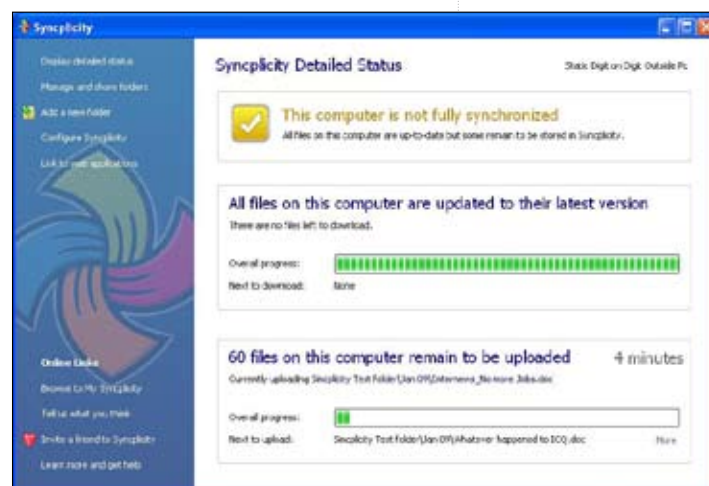
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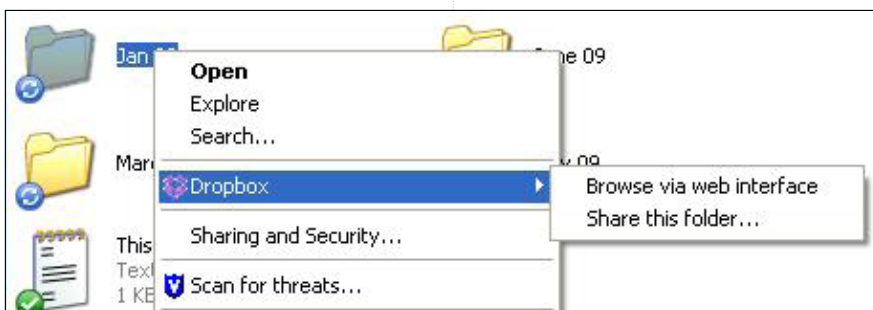
off-line copies across all your computers.

Once you install the small application and the Synclipcity wizard appears, enter your email address, password, and a name for your computer. Synclipcity will then link your computer to your Synclipcity account. Next, tell Synclipcity what you'd like to synchronise and backup on that computer. Synclipcity will let you pick your folders as the wizard completes. It will do the initial backup in the

background, automatically. You can click the



Synclipcity Synchronisation



Right-clicking on any folder brings up the Dropbox options

tray icon at anytime to find out the status of the backup. Like others, this application also integrates into Windows Explorer and gives you various right-click options and icon overlays. Head over to the Synclipcity website to view your files and folders through the web interface from any computer. To sync with another computer simply download the client on another PC and link it to your account. It's synclip!

Through the web interface you can click on the menu icon to view revision history for a particular file. Click on the Applications tab to associate Synclipcity with your Google Docs and Facebook account. It must be emphasised here that the Google Docs sync with the service is pretty erratic and may not work at all. But once a link with your Google Docs account is established you should get a copy of all the docs in the cloud on your local drive. The two will always be kept in sync – any document you create or change in Google Docs should immediately appear on your computers and vice-versa. The service boasts of a number of safety measures incorporated into this sync process. For instance, when there is a conflict between versions, it will save both copies side-by-side and have you decide which one you want. If you delete a file in either location, the delete will reflect in all the synchronised places; but a copy will always be maintained in the online recycle bin with Synclipcity.

In case of rich documents with features such as comments and track changes, which are not supported by Google Docs, Synclipcity will maintain the rich copy on your hard drive while removing those features from the online version.

So in conclusion you now have several options; each of them provide you with a few unique features

to cover your file synchronisation needs. Some services provide simplicity while others provide cross platform support or cloud integration. Power users can opt for one of the paid services or upgrade a free service they like to a premium version. However, in our opinion Dropbox seems to be the most well rounded of the lot. Whatever service you eventually settle on, one thing is for sure - the days of leaving files behind and over dependence on USB drives are over.